

Aztecs, Incas, and Mayas

Three great civilizations grew up in the ancient Americas. They were called the Aztecs, Mayas, and Incas. These people built great cities and temples to their gods.

Aztec warrior headdress

Where did they live?

The Aztecs and Mayas ruled large parts of Mexico and Central America. The Inca Empire stretched along the west coast of South America.



Aztec temple

Aztec temples looked like pyramids, with steps leading to a shrine on top. Here, the Aztecs killed people and offered their hearts to the god of the Sun.

This is Chicomecoatl, the Aztec goddess of maize.

Gods and farming

The Aztecs prayed to the gods to make their crops grow. Most important was maize (corn). It was ground into flour for making flat breads called tortillas.

